Memories

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/55686670.

Rating:
Teen And Up Audiences

Archive Warning:
Creator Chose Not To Use Archive Warnings

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F/F, F/M

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Adora/Catra (She-Ra), He-Man | Adam/Teela, Marlena/Randor (He-Man), Netossa/Spinnerella (She-Ra)

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Grief/Mourning, Catra is Bad at Feelings (She-Ra), Adora is in Love with Catra (She-Ra), Summer Vacation, Spinntossa Catra aunts, Swiftwind the service dog, Catra had dads, Soft Adora/Catra (She-Ra), Established Adora/Catra (She-Ra), Established Relationship, Emotional Hurt/Comfort, Bilingual Character(s), Catra speaks Spanish

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Part 2 of The Blonde Next Door

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by AstrynSerene

Summary

Surprised with a joint summer vacation, Adora, Catra, Adam, and Teela get to visit Salineas and go to the beach. Unfortunately, seeing her friends with their parents reminds Catra of the one thing she doesn't have.

OR

Catra has a mental break grieving the loss of her fathers and her family is there for her.

Notes

This takes place pretty quickly after the end of The Blonde Next Door, and is my segue way into the sequel The Blonde in My Arms! Enjoy some Hurt/Comfort and lil Fluffs! to hold you over to the sequel! <3

See the end of the work for more notes

The trip had been a surprise for all of the teens. The parents had gotten together not long before the school year ended and decided to take the kids on vacation to Salineas over the summer. Everyone was super excited, especially Adora once the concept of traveling and vacations were explained to her.

Their small group chat had blown up the night before they left, Adam super excited for swimming and fishing, while Teela and Catra were more excited in volleyball and tanning on the beach. Adora was excited about leaving Brightmoon and seeing more of the world in general.

The parents had agreed to let the kids share a hotel room while they took another, and Catra was quick to plop down on the bed closest to the window, "I thought we were gonna flip a coin on the window bed?" Adam chuckled, sitting next to Teela on the opposite bed.

"I don't recall any such deal." Catra smirked, "Besides, Adora loves the view." She nodded over to the blonde, who was staring out at the beach in the distance with peak interest.

"Fineee.." Adam huffed with faux frustration, setting his suitcase down at the foot of the other bed.

Swiftwind barked once, licking Adam's cheek as if to cheer him up before going over to Adora's side and sitting down at her feet, "It's so pretty!" Adora smiled, watching the waves rolling into the shore.

"Mermista grew up here, she texted me like fifty different shops and restaurants she said we had to visit." Catra chuckled.

"Guess we'll have a full itinerary then." Teela smiled, sitting down after putting her suitcase on the bed.

"Honestly, we might even see her at some point. I know her dad lives here." Adam pulled his phone charger from his bag and plugged it in to one of the outlets between the bed. He laughed

when he looked up and saw Adora still staring out the window at the beach, "Excited for the beach, Adora?"

The blonde looked back, lightly blushing, "Yeah. It's really pretty! Can we go?"

"We will, princess. We just need to settle in first." Catra giggled, stepping up to her and nuzzling her cheek. Adora blushed, hugging the brunette.

⚔

After putting their things away and changing, the teens met their parents in the lobby before making their way across the street to the beach, everyone holding chairs or tote bags. After picking a spot and setting up, Catra made sure to sit Adora down and cover her in sunscreen.

"Catra!" Adora giggled, flinching from the ticklish touch of Catra rubbing sunscreen on her back.

"You'll thank me later, trust me." Catra laughed, finishing up with a boop on her nose, gently rubbing the lotion in.

"I know, I know..!" The blonde wrapped her arms around Catra once she was done, drawing a shriek out of her as she was pulled against her.

"Hey!"

"Whaaaat?" Adora giggled innocently, "Don't you need sunscreen too?"

"My fur is protection enough! Now it's gonna be gross and sticky." Catra pouted, though it melted away when Adora pressed their lips together, "Mm." She wrapped her arms around Adora's shoulders, "You're brushing my fur later."

"Okay!"

“And Adora is officially paler than ever.” Adam teased, ruffling her hair as he passed by them.

“Hey!” Adora pouted, fixing her ponytail.

“As if you aren’t just as covered.” Teela snorted, leaning back in her chair.

Blushing, Adam rolled his eyes, “Are you guys coming in the water?”

Adora nodded eagerly, getting to her feet, taking Randor’s hand when he offered it, “Are you coming?” She asked, looking back at Catra.

“I’ll catch up in a minute, princess.” The brunette smiled, watching the twins and their parents head down into the waves. Adora was almost immediately clinging to her father, watching the water in wonder. She smiled, her tail wrapping around her legs as she watched her partner. She had never learned to swim of course, so she was staying in the shallow, moving back and forth between her mom and dad while Adam swam around them, laughing about something.

The sight was adorable, and she loved seeing Adora getting experiences she should have had years ago, but the familial sight reminded her of her lack of time with her fathers.

“Dad!”

Her ear flicked towards Teela, glancing over and spotting Duncan and Teela sitting under the umbrella, doodling with sticks in the sand and laughing about something. She took a deep breath, looking back out to the water.

Don’t do this right now, Catra. This is a fun day, don’t break down now. Not in front of everyone like this. You’re stronger than this..! You’re- You’re better than this! Don’t- Don’t-

She flinched when she felt arms wrap around her. She sniffed, realizing she was shaking and tears were running down her face.

“Oh dulce bebé, está bien, está bien..” Netossa whispered in her ear, sitting down and gently pulling her into her lap, “Take a deep breath, love…”

Spinnerella took a seat next to her wife, offering her hand to her niece, who grabbed it almost immediately.

Catra gasped, turning to the side and burying her face in Netossa’s shoulder, “I- I’m okay…!”

“Baby, don’t…” Spinnerella frowned, “We’ve got you, you’re safe..”

“I- I didn’t- I..”

“I know, I know..” Netossa kissed the top of her head, “It’s okay to miss them, sweetheart..”

Catra flinched again when she felt something nudging her side. She looked over, and Swiftwind took the chance to lay his head down on her lap, whining softly. Sniffing, Catra started petting his head with her free hand, “H-hey, Swifty…” She whispered, taking a deep breath and slowly exhaling.

Swiftwind’s tail started to wag, sensing that his person’s mate was calming down.

“Good boy.” Spinnerella smiled, petting his back.

“Catra?”

The brunette flinched and looked up to see Adora walking up to her, a concerned look on her face.

“Are you okay?”

“Yeah, princess, I’m okay.” She smiled, watching her girlfriend take a seat next to her.

“Why are you crying..?”

“I just…” Catra sighed, “Missing my dads, that’s all.”

Frowning, Adora scooted closer, nudging Swiftwind off her and taking her partner into her arms, “Anything I can do?”

“This is enough…” Catra smiled, hugging her and resting her head on her shoulder, “Thank you, love…” She added in a whisper, purring when Adora kissed the top of her head.

“We can stay here for the day if it’ll help you feel better.”

“No, that’s okay. Maybe swimming will help take my mind off things.”

“Okay, whatever helps.” Adora smiled.

They stayed on the blanket for a few more minutes until Catra was ready to get up. The couple slowly made their way down to the water, Swiftwind racing ahead and splashing in the waves once he was sure they were okay.

The feeling of the waves against her legs made Catra tense initially. Water had never been her best friend, but she knew Adora would take care of her later. She relaxed when Adora wrapped her arms around her, sitting together on one of the floaties they’d brought with them. She started purring when Adora gently caressed her hair, smiling slightly, “I love you…”

“Love you too!” Adora smiled, kissing her cheek.

⚔

Catra didn’t realize they’d been floating around for two hours until Marlena called Adora to reapply sunscreen. They only stayed out for another few hours after that before returning to the hotel to shower and relax.

After a quick shower though, Catra was resigned to sitting on the bed while Adora gently combed through her fur, getting rid of tangled and controlling the tufts of fluff that had popped up after swimming and showering.

"Anddd... done!" Adora smiled, setting the comb next to her on the bed, "No more tangles or sand."

"Thank you..." Catra smiled, turning and kissing Adora's cheek, "I really appreciate it."

"Of course, it's not a problem." Adora blushed, "Truthfully doing something intricate like that is self stimulating for me, gives me something to focus on."

"Well, I'm glad we're both getting benefits." Catra chuckled, before frowning, "I'm- sorry about earlier. I didn't mean to break down like that. This is supposed to be a vacation and-"

"Stop." Adora said, softly but firmly, "What do you always tell me?"

"That I love you?"

Adora raised an eyebrow.

"...that being emotional isn't a bad thing."

"Mhm. You getting upset is okay, and we're all here for you. I'm here for you. You can't control these things, just like I can't." She gently slid her hand over Catra's, squeezing lightly, "You're always here for me through my mess of a recovery, you're crazy if you think I'm not gonna do the same thing for you."

Blinking back tears, Catra wrapped her arms around Adora, hugging her tightly, "I love you..."

"I love you too." Adora smiled, kissing her forehead.

"Hey guys! Guess what I found?" Adam laughed, stepping into the hotel room, Teela at his side, "I found my Uno cards!"

"Are you trying to ruin this friendship?" Catra laughed.

"Awe come on! We don't have much else to do in here. Besides! We can teach Adora how to play."

"Watch her beat your ass at it." Teela snickered, plopping down on the other bed and taking her ponytail down to brush her hair out.

"Well- there's only one way to find out isn't there?" Adam smirked, laughing when Catra gave a sigh that meant she'd conceded.

"Fine, why not. But if you get the claws you can only blame yourself!" Catra laughed, getting up to grab the chair from the small table in the room, setting it between the beds to use as a table, "Gimme the cards, I know how to shuffle."

"Yes!" Adam handed Catra the deck, everyone getting comfortable for the evening.

Catra knew she would always wonder what life would have been like if her fathers were alive, but she knew she wouldn't have played her life out any other way. She missed them so much she'd thrown up before, but she knew that without living next door to the mystery blonde, the beautiful ever growing family she had now wouldn't be possible.

She knew her fathers were proud of her, that they loved her, and that the family she had now loved her just as much.

End Notes

I'd love to hear what you think and what you think/want to see in The Blonde in My Arms!! <3

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!